

Instaclustr announces new data management service based on Apache Kafka

Instaclustr has launched its Apache Kafka managed service to help manage high volumes of data streams in real-time.

Apache Kafka is open source data streaming software that aims to provide a unified, high-throughput, low-latency platform for handling real-time data feeds. Due to the easy access of the service, many of the organisations are deploying it to manage their high volumes of data.

Some special features have been added to benefit customers by providing low latency and zero downtime



migration, enabling no service interruption. The service focuses on

the monitoring and alerting required to understand customer data streams. It also provides 24x7 technical support and a choice of cloud provider accounts.

Apache Kafka is available for many cloud environments, including AWS, Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud Platform, and IBM Cloud.

Apart from its features, it has four main categories that include storage, analytics, search and messaging. The first three are already covered with Cassandra, Spark and Elasticsearch, so messaging is the latest category added.

The initial focus will be on selling Kafka to Instaclustr's 100-plus existing enterprise customers. The service would be useful for any customer building applications that need to scale, and where a messaging system is required to optimise the overall architecture.

Customers who want to align data on their own have to find experts and build a team to optimise the applications and architecture. They must be available 24x7 in case anything goes wrong, which is expensive, and it takes time to build such a team. But by switching to Kafka, they can do it in a much simpler and cheaper way.

At the American Red Cross, VP of disaster cycle services, Brad Kieserman said, "Responding to large-scale national and international disasters is a team effort, and we are excited to leverage skills and insights from the tech industry to address global challenges."

Call for Code invites developers to create new applications to help communities and people prepare better for natural disasters. For example, developers may create an app that uses weather data and supply chain information to alert pharmacies to increase supplies of medicine, bottled water and other items, based on predicted weather-related disruption.

It could also be an app that predicts when and where the disaster will be most severe so emergency crews can be dispatched ahead of time in proper numbers to treat those in need. IBM's US\$ 30 million contribution over five years will fund access to developer tools, technologies, free code and training with experts.



The winning team will receive a financial prize; yet perhaps more rewarding, it will have access to long-term support to help move its ideas from prototypes to real-world applications. This includes ongoing developer support through IBM's partnership with The Linux Foundation.

Winning submissions need a strong ecosystem to ensure that they will flourish and continue to be deployed across the globe, long after the competition ends. "That's where The Linux Foundation is proud to step in and help equip open source projects with the tools needed to accelerate adoption," said the executive director of The Linux Foundation, Jim Zemlin.

In addition to development support, the winning team can join one of IBM's Corporate Service Corps (CSC) teams to apply their ideas to a community in need. IBM CSC teams are made up of multi-disciplinary experts who spend four to six weeks in underserved communities around the world to apply technology to local issues and opportunities.

IBM is the founding member of 'Call for Code' and this initiative was created to realise the full potential of developers as they play a critical role in driving innovation that can shape and save lives.

To raise awareness and interest in the initiative, IBM is coordinating interactive educational events, hackathons and community support for developers around the world in more than 50 cities, including Amsterdam, Bengaluru, Berlin, Delhi, Dubai, London, New York, San Francisco, Sao Paulo and Tel Aviv.